



WE TEACH. WE COACH. WE SUPPORT.

ILS Staff Training: Scope of Service & Workers' Compensation

We are Independent Living Services instructors — not caregivers. We never lift, transfer, or carry clients.

For ILS staff serving adults with disabilities • California

Why This Training

By the end, you will be able to...



Explain what ILS is — and what it is not

Teaching independence vs. providing care



State the absolute rules

No lifting, transferring, carrying, or hands-on personal care — ever



Say "no" kindly and redirect

Handle out-of-scope requests from clients and families



Report a work injury correctly

California workers' comp steps, from first report to DWC-1

What ILS Is: Our Role

Independent Living Services builds skills for independent life

THE GOLDEN RULE

**Do WITH,
never FOR.**

Every task done FOR a client removes a learning opportunity. Our hands demonstrate and take notes — the client's hands do the task.



Meal planning, cooking, kitchen safety



Budgeting, banking, paying bills



Housekeeping routines & laundry — coached



Public transit & community mobility training



Scheduling & communicating at medical visits



Self-advocacy & connecting to resources (IHSS)

What ILS Is NOT: We Are Not Caregivers

Personal care is a different service, by different workers



ILS WORKER (you)

- Teaches, demonstrates, prompts, coaches
- Builds the client's own skills
- Connects clients to the right services
- Documents needs and reports gaps



CAREGIVER (not you)

- Lifts, transfers, and physically supports
- Bathes, dresses, toilets, feeds
- IHSS providers, PCAs, CNAs, home health
- Different training, funding & insurance

The Absolute Rules

Never — not "just this once," not even if the client or family asks



NO LIFTING

Not from the floor, a bed, or anywhere else



NO TRANSFERRING

Wheelchair ↔ bed, toilet, couch, or car — never



NO CARRYING

Including stairs and "just a few steps"



NO CATCHING FALLS

Guide hazards away, call for help — don't be the cushion



NO PERSONAL CARE

No bathing, toileting, dressing, or feeding by hand



NO GIVING MEDS

Prompt and teach systems — never place or administer

Why These Rules Exist

Five reasons — and every one of them protects a person



Client safety

Safe transfers need training, assessment, and equipment (gait belts, Hoyer lifts) we don't have. Untrained transfers cause falls and fractures.



Your safety

Lifting people is a leading cause of career-ending back injuries in human services.



Scope of service

We are vended to teach and coach — not to provide attendant care. Out-of-scope work jeopardizes contracts and the client's services.



Insurance & liability

Coverage is built around what ILS workers actually do. Hands-on care exposes you, the client, and the agency.



The client's support plan

If we quietly fill a care gap, the real need never gets documented — and never gets properly funded (e.g., IHSS hours).

DO / DON'T: Mobility, Falls & Transfers

The highest-risk category — know it cold



DO — within your role

Walk beside an independent walker; give verbal cues ("curb coming up")

Coach clients through using their own mobility equipment as their PT/OT taught

After a fall: assess verbally, call 911 if injured, coach self-recovery only if uninjured & able

Clear paths, hold doors, steady a grocery cart



DON'T — outside your role

Let a client bear weight on you or use you as a human walker

Transfer a client between wheelchair, bed, toilet, couch, or car

Lift or pull a fallen client off the floor — even a small client who insists they're fine

Catch a falling client with your body

DO / DON'T: Personal Care & Meals

Teach the routine — never touch the task



DO — within your role

Post a hygiene checklist; prompt from outside the bathroom:
"What's next on your list?"

Teach dressing techniques with adaptive tools (button hooks, reachers)

Plan the menu together; the CLIENT chops, stirs, and plates while you coach

Report hygiene or continence concerns so the right service can address them



DON'T — outside your role

Bathe, shower, or wash any part of a client's body — or assist with toileting

Physically dress or undress a client

Cook the meal yourself while the client watches — or feed a client by hand

Handle personal care "just this once" because no one else is there

DO / DON'T: Carrying, Errands & Medication

Groceries, laundry, equipment — and the medicine cabinet



DO — within your role

Coach clients to carry their own bags, use a rolling cart, or request store carry-out

Help arrange delivery or moving help from appropriate services

Teach med systems: pill organizers, phone alarms, pharmacy auto-refill; prompt "It's 8 o'clock — what happens at 8?"

Report missed meds, side effects, or health changes to your supervisor promptly



DON'T — outside your role

Routinely carry the client's groceries, laundry, or belongings

Move furniture or lift wheelchairs/scooters in and out of vehicles

Place pills in a client's mouth, decide about doses, or give injections

Give medical advice or change any part of a medication routine

If a Client Falls

The protocol — every time, no exceptions

1

DON'T LIFT

Do not lift, pull, or catch.
Keep the client still and calm.

2

ASSESS VERBALLY

"Are you hurt? Where? Can you move your arms and legs?"

3

CALL 911

If injured — or if you're unsure. Let EMS do the lifting.

4

COACH SELF-RECOVERY

Only if clearly uninjured and able: talk them through getting up the way you've practiced.

5

REPORT & DOCUMENT

Call your supervisor same-day and file an incident report — even for "no harm" falls.

A staff member who lifts a fallen adult usually creates a second patient.

How to Say No — and Still Be Kind

Expect these moments. Have the words ready.

"Can you just help me up?"

"I'm not allowed to lift you, and I won't risk hurting you or me. Are you hurt anywhere? OK — I'll coach you up the way we practiced, or call the right help."

"The last worker used to shower him."

"Showering is personal care — outside what ILS can do, for his safety and mine. What I CAN do is help get personal care hours set up. Let me call my supervisor today."

"Just carry my laundry down."

"Let's solve it so it works every week — smaller loads, the rolling cart, or your IHSS provider. Which do you want to try?"



THE THREE-STEP REDIRECT: 1) Decline warmly and briefly. 2) Offer what you CAN do. 3) Report the request to your supervisor the same day — every out-of-scope ask is an unmet need the client's team must know about.

Workers' Compensation: Your Safety Net

No-fault insurance every California employer must carry



Medical care

Treatment for work injuries and illness: doctor, hospital, PT, medication — paid by the claim, not by you.



Wage replacement

Temporary disability pays part of your wages if your doctor takes you off work; permanent disability if you don't fully recover.



Protection from retaliation

It is **ILLEGAL** to punish or fire you for reporting an injury or filing a claim (Labor Code §132a).



Honesty required

Report real injuries promptly. Knowingly filing a false claim is a felony.

Injured at Work? Six Steps, In Order

Report EVERYTHING — even injuries that seem minor. Small strains become big claims.

1

Get medical help first

911 / ER for emergencies. Tell the provider it's a work injury.

2

Tell your supervisor immediately

Same shift whenever possible. (Legal outer limit: 30 days — but never wait.)

3

Complete the DWC-1 claim form

The agency must give it to you within ONE working day of learning of your injury. Fill out the employee section, sign, return, keep a copy.

4

Get treatment

Up to \$10,000 in care must be authorized even while the claim is investigated. Use the agency's medical network unless you predesignated your doctor in writing.

5

Follow through

Keep appointments, follow restrictions exactly, keep copies of everything.

6

File an incident report

Every injury AND every near-miss — it protects you and prevents the next one.

The Role in One Sentence

Then: quiz, sign, and file

"I teach and coach independent living skills. I do tasks WITH clients, never FOR them — and never with my body as the tool."

NEVER

Lift • Transfer • Carry • Catch a fall • Bathe / toilet / dress / feed • Administer meds • Move furniture • Handle client money

ALWAYS

Teach • Demonstrate • Prompt • Coach • Problem-solve • Connect to the right service • Report unmet needs • Report ALL injuries same-day

Next: complete the 12-question knowledge check and sign the acknowledgment form for your personnel file.